

Opportunity Qualification Checklist

Is this prospect worth a first message? Seven quick questions, answered by hand.

This checklist answers exactly one question: **is this prospect worth a first message?** It is not a project-scoping tool, a pricing tool, or a way to qualify a proposal — those come later, only once someone has actually replied. Answer each question honestly, in your own judgment; there is no automated scoring here.

Question	Your answer (circle one)
1. Real, active presence Do they have a real, active business presence you can verify — a working website, an active social profile, or a physical location? (Not just a name you found somewhere.)	YES NO
2. One concrete, visible gap Can you point to one specific, visible gap or pain point — something you actually saw, not a vague "they could probably be doing better"?	YES NO
3. Plausible ability to pay Does the business look active and established enough to plausibly pay for help — recent posts, multiple reviews, visible customer activity?	YES NO
4. A reachable decision-maker Can you identify or reach an actual owner or manager, rather than only a generic contact form or shared inbox?	YES NO
5. A service you actually offer Is the gap something you can genuinely help with today, using a service you already offer — not something you'd need to learn first?	YES NO
6. Not already solved for them As far as you can tell, is this gap not something they've already fixed, or that's commonly offered free in this exact market?	YES NO
7. Low-cost to try Would reaching out cost you nothing but the time to write one honest message — no paid tools, travel, or favor owed to someone else?	YES NO

How to read your answers

If you answered **NO to two or more** questions, hold off — look for a better-fit prospect rather than sending a message you don't believe in. A single "no" is often fine on its own (few real prospects are perfect); it's the combination that signals a weak fit.

This is a quick filter for whether a first message is worth sending — nothing more. It does not scope a project, set a price, or decide whether someone will become a client. Once a prospect replies, move to researching and scoping the actual work, not back through this list.